

Subject continuums: Language

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Primary Years Programme

Subject continuums: Language

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IB mission statement

The International Baccalaureate aims to develop inquiring, knowledgeable and caring young people who help to create a better and more peaceful world through intercultural understanding and respect.

To this end the organization works with schools, governments and international organizations to develop challenging programmes of international education and rigorous assessment.

These programmes encourage students across the world to become active, compassionate and lifelong learners who understand that other people, with their differences, can also be right.



IB learner profile

The aim of all IB programmes is to develop internationally minded people who, recognizing their common humanity and shared guardianship of the planet, help to create a better and more peaceful world.

As IB learners we strive to be:

INQUIRERS

We nurture our curiosity, developing skills for inquiry and research. We know how to learn independently and with others. We learn with enthusiasm and sustain our love of learning throughout life.

KNOWLEDGEABLE

We develop and use conceptual understanding, exploring knowledge across a range of disciplines. We engage with issues and ideas that have local and global significance.

THINKERS

We use critical and creative thinking skills to analyse and take responsible action on complex problems. We exercise initiative in making reasoned, ethical decisions.

COMMUNICATORS

We express ourselves confidently and creatively in more than one language and in many ways. We collaborate effectively, listening carefully to the perspectives of other individuals and groups.

PRINCIPLED

We act with integrity and honesty, with a strong sense of fairness and justice, and with respect for the dignity and rights of people everywhere. We take responsibility for our actions and their consequences.

OPEN-MINDED

We critically appreciate our own cultures and personal histories, as well as the values and traditions of others. We seek and evaluate a range of points of view, and we are willing to grow from the experience.

CARING

We show empathy, compassion and respect. We have a commitment to service, and we act to make a positive difference in the lives of others and in the world around us.

RISK-TAKERS

We approach uncertainty with forethought and determination; we work independently and cooperatively to explore new ideas and innovative strategies. We are resourceful and resilient in the face of challenges and change.

BALANCED

We understand the importance of balancing different aspects of our lives—intellectual, physical, and emotional—to achieve well-being for ourselves and others. We recognize our interdependence with other people and with the world in which we live.

REFLECTIVE

We thoughtfully consider the world and our own ideas and experience. We work to understand our strengths and weaknesses in order to support our learning and personal development.

The IB learner profile represents 10 attributes valued by IB World Schools. We believe these attributes, and others like them, can help individuals and groups become responsible members of local, national and global communities.

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Language strands

Oral language— listening and speaking

Oral language encompasses all aspects of listening and speaking—skills that are essential for ongoing language development, for learning and for relating to others. Listening (the receptive mode) and speaking (the expressive mode) work together in a *transactional process* between listeners and speakers to create an oral *text*. A balanced programme will provide meaningful and well-planned opportunities for learners to participate as listeners as well as speakers. Listening involves more than just hearing sounds. It requires active and conscious attention in order to make sense of what is heard. Purposeful talk enables learners to articulate thoughts as they construct and reconstruct meaning to understand the world around them. Oral language involves recognizing and using certain types of language according to the audience and purposes (for example, the language used at home, the language of the classroom, the language of play, the language of inquiry, conversations with peers, giving instructions, interpreting creative texts, the language of fantasy, the language of different generations, of different times and places).

Visual language— viewing and presenting

The receptive process (viewing) and expressive processes (presenting) are connected and allow for growth in understanding; neither process has meaning except in relation to the other. These processes involve navigating and interpreting, using and constructing visuals and multimedia in a variety of situations and for a range of purposes and audiences. They allow students to understand the ways in which images and language interact to convey ideas, values and beliefs. Visual texts may be paper, digital or live, observable forms of communication that are consciously constructed to convey meaning and immediately engage viewers, allowing them instant access to data. Examples include advertisements, artworks, computer games, websites, movies, signs, logos, maps, graphs, cartoons and performances. It is important to provide a balanced programme with opportunities for students to understand and use the structures and features involved in viewing and presenting text.

Written language— reading

Reading is a developmental process that involves constructing meaning from text. The process is interactive and involves the reader's purpose for reading, the reader's prior knowledge and experience, and the text itself. It begins to happen when the young learner realizes that symbols, writing and print convey meaning and becomes concerned with trying to make sense of the marks on the page. Reading helps clarify ideas, feelings, thoughts and opinions. Literature offers a means of understanding ourselves and others, and has the power to influence and structure thinking. Well-written fiction provides opportunities for learners to imagine themselves in another's situation, reflecting on feelings and actions, and developing empathy. The ability to read and comprehend non-fiction is essential for the process of inquiry. As inquirers, learners need to be able to identify, synthesize and apply useful and relevant information from text. Children learn to read by engaging with texts and through learning skills, integrating and practising these skills in meaningful contexts to develop fluency and build vocabulary. As learners engage with interesting and appealing texts, appropriate to their experiences and developmental phase, they learn the skills, strategies and conceptual understanding necessary to become competent, motivated, independent readers.

**Written language—
writing**

People use writing as a way of organizing and communicating thoughts, ideas and information in order to express themselves in a visible and tangible way. It is a personal act that grows and develops with the individual. In *multimodal* texts, writing is often integrated with visual modes to reinforce meaning. Writing is primarily concerned with communicating meaning and intention. When children are encouraged to express themselves and reveal their own “voice”, writing is a genuine expression of the individual. Over time, writing involves developing a variety of skills, structures, strategies and literary techniques (spelling, grammar, plot, character, punctuation, voice) and applying them with increasing skill and effectiveness. The writer’s ability to communicate their intention and share meaning takes precedence over accuracy and the application of skills, as accuracy and skills grow out of the process of producing meaningful communication. Children learn to write by writing. Acquiring a set of isolated skills will not turn them into writers. It is in the process of sharing their ideas in written form that skills are developed, applied and refined to produce increasingly effective written communication.

Overall expectations

Overall expectations				
Strand: Oral language—listening and speaking				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners show an understanding of the value of speaking and listening to communicate. They recognize that sounds are associated with objects, or with <i>symbolic representations</i> of them. They use language to name their environment, to get to know each other, to initiate and explore relationships, and to question and inquire.	Learners show an understanding that sounds are associated with objects, events and ideas, or with symbolic representations of them. They are aware that an object or symbol may have different sounds or words associated with it in different languages. They are compiling rules about the use of different aspects of language. They are beginning to be aware of the high degree of variability of language and its uses.	Learners show an understanding of the wide range of purposes of spoken language: that it instructs, informs, entertains, reassures; that each listener's perception of what they hear is unique. They show an understanding of the conventions associated with speaking and listening and the value of adhering to those conventions. They are aware that language is a vehicle for becoming knowledgeable; for negotiating understanding; and for negotiating the <i>social dimension</i> .	Learners show an understanding of the difference between literal and figurative language, and how to use language differently for different purposes. They are aware that they are building on their previous experiences and using language to construct new meaning.	

Overall expectations				
Strand: Visual language—viewing and presenting				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners show an understanding that the world around them is full of visual language that conveys meaning. They are able to interpret and respond to visual texts. Although much of their own visual language is spontaneous, they are extending and using visual language in more purposeful ways.	Learners identify, interpret and respond to a range of visual text prompts and show an understanding that different types of visual texts serve different purposes. Learners show an understanding that visual text may represent reality or fantasy. They recognize that visual text resources can provide factual information and increase understanding. They use this knowledge to create their own visual texts for particular purposes.	Learners show an open-mindedness about the use of a range of visual text resources to access information. Learners use visual text in a reflective way to enrich their storytelling or presentations, and to organize and represent information. They think critically and are articulate about the use of visual text to influence the viewer. They are able to use visual imagery to present factual information, or to tell a story.	Through inquiry, learners engage with an increasing range of visual text resources. As well as exploring the viewing and presenting strategies that are a part of the planned learning environment, they select and use strategies that suit their learning styles. They are able to make connections between visual imagery and social commentary. They show more discernment in selecting information they consider reliable. They are able to use visual imagery to support a position.	

Overall expectations				
Strand: Written language—reading				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners show an understanding that print represents the real or the imagined world. They know that reading gives them knowledge and pleasure; that it can be a social activity or an individual activity. They have a concept of a “book”, and an awareness of some of its structural elements. They use visual clues to recall sounds and the words they are “reading” to construct meaning. Depending on the orthography of the language, these clues might include letters, symbols, pinyin, kanji, strokes or characters.	Learners show an understanding that language can be represented visually through codes and symbols. They are extending their knowledge and understanding of printed codes and symbols, and are able to recognize them in new contexts. They understand that reading is a vehicle for learning, and that the combination of codes and symbols conveys meaning. They use strategies, based on what they know, to read for understanding. They recognize that the structure and organization of text conveys meaning.	Learners show an understanding that text is used to convey meaning in different ways and for different purposes—they are developing an awareness of context. Learners show an understanding of the relationship between reading, thinking and reflection. They know that reading is extending their world, both real and imagined, and that there is a reciprocal relationship between the two. They have established reading routines and relish the process of reading.	Learners show an understanding of the strategies authors use to engage them. They have their favourite authors and can articulate reasons for their choices. Reading provides a sense of accomplishment, not only in the process, but in the access it provides to further knowledge about, and understanding of, the world.	

Overall expectations				
Strand: Written language–writing				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners show an understanding that writing is a form of expression to be enjoyed. They know that how you write and what you write convey meaning; that writing is a purposeful act, with both individual and collaborative aspects.	Learners show an understanding that writing is a means of recording, remembering and communicating. They know that writing involves the use of codes and symbols to convey meaning to others; that writing and reading uses the same codes and symbols. They know that writing can describe the real or the imagined world. They can tell a story and create characters in their writing.	Learners show an understanding that writing can be structured in different ways to express different purposes. They show an understanding of the role of the author and are able to take on the responsibilities of authorship. They demonstrate an understanding of story structure and are able to make critical judgements about their writing, and the writing of others. They use imagery in their stories to enhance the meaning and to make it more enjoyable to write and read. They understand that writing can produce a variety of responses from readers. They are able to rewrite to improve the quality of their writing.	Learners show an understanding of the conventions pertaining to writing, in its different forms, that are widely accepted. In addition, they demonstrate a high level of integration of the strands of language in order to create meaning in a manner that suits their learning styles. They can analyse the writing of others and identify common or recurring themes or issues. They accept feedback from others.	

Strand: Oral language—listening and speaking

Example concepts: audience, communication, ethical, figurative, grammar, influence, interpretation, literal, meaning, message, modality, pattern, perspective, purpose, sounds, structure, symbols, techniques, translanguaging, voice.

Example conceptual understandings				
Strand: Oral language—listening and speaking				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Different languages may be spoken at home or in the community.	Language helps people to develop their understanding of each other as they interact.	Thinking about the perspective of others helps people to communicate more effectively.	<i>Multiliteracies</i> enable people to engage with text and to communicate responsibly and ethically in multiple modes and languages.	
Ideas, feelings and needs can be communicated with others in a variety of modes, including gestures, actions and body language.	Everyone has the right to speak and be listened to, and people interpret messages according to their unique experiences and ways of understanding.	The rules of spoken language vary according to context, purpose and audience, but language variability is normal.	Listeners identify key ideas in spoken language and synthesize them to create and communicate their own understanding.	
People explore sounds and patterns as part of learning languages.	The sounds of language are a symbolic way of representing ideas and objects.	The features and grammatical structures of a language enable members of a language community to communicate with each other.	Communicators engage with language learning in multiple contexts in a range of modes.	
Play is a way of developing communication skills, building relationships and having fun.	Multilingual learners use <i>translanguaging</i> to make sense of and interact with the world round them.	Creating texts is a social endeavour and language is a tool for collaborating with others.	Language learning is developed through its use in different contexts and through reflection and setting goals for improvement.	

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Oral language—listening and speaking				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners: - realize that people speak different languages (for example, home languages, community languages) - recognize that the way people greet or speak to others differs according to context (for example, formal, informal, cultural, generational) - use home language(s) (with translation, if necessary) to express needs and express ideas - use gestures, actions, body language and/or words to communicate needs and to express ideas - listen and respond to a range of texts, showing enjoyment and understanding through gestures, expression and words - recognize that words and sentences help people to express ideas - reproduce the sounds of the target language and begin to recognize how these sounds connect to the written representation of them - realize that word order can change from one language to another - understand simple questions and respond with actions or words - follow classroom directions and routines, using context cues	Learners: - listen and respond in small or large group discussions for increasing periods of time - remember and join in with poems, rhymes, songs, games and classroom routines - use oral language to communicate and build understanding during classroom activities and routines, conversations and play - use spoken language to communicate information relating to their personal experiences - ask questions or express wonderings to gain information and respond to their own or others' inquiries - recognize the value of being able to communicate in more than one language - recognize that taking turns to speak and listen is part of respectful interactions that build relationships - use language to address their needs, and express feelings and opinions - identify and describe main events and relevant points in oral texts with increasing confidence and detail - anticipate and predict when listening to texts	Learners: - respect contributions from others and reflect on different perspectives offered - listen appreciatively and responsively, presenting their own point of view and respecting the views of others - argue persuasively and defend a point of view - organize thoughts and feelings before speaking - understand that different contexts may have different language expectations - hear and appreciate differences between languages and language variations, such as dialects - gather information from a range of sources, including peers and texts - use note-taking strategies when gathering information from oral and visual texts - identify and expand on main ideas in oral text - understand and use specific vocabulary to suit different purposes (for example, to explain, narrate or instruct) and audiences - recognize when the language or techniques used in texts are trying to influence thinking	Learners: - participate appropriately as listener and speaker, in discussions, conversations, debates and presentations - argue persuasively and justify a point of view - show open-minded attitudes when listening to other points of view - identify techniques and language in multimodal texts that aim to influence or mislead the listener; evaluate and challenge sources - appreciate that people speak and respond according to personal and cultural perspectives - use more complex vocabulary and sentence structures with a high level of specificity to communicate - understand and use figurative language such as simile, personification and metaphor - use standard grammatical structures and phonological features competently in appropriate situations - use register, voice-level intonation and stress to emphasize or enhance meaning	

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Oral language—listening and speaking				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
• use their own grammar style as part of the process of developing grammatical awareness • interact with peers and adults in familiar social settings, and share information about self, family and interests with peers and adults through play situations • tell their own stories using words, gestures and objects/artefacts • build vocabulary through listening and speaking as part of play and teacher-facilitated experiences.	• distinguish and use sounds of the target language with increasing accuracy (for example, initial, medial and final sounds of words; intonation; stress, tones) • use grammatical rules of the language(s) of instruction or language variations, such as dialects (learners may overgeneralize at this stage) • recognize patterns in language(s) and use increasingly accurate grammar and pronunciation in the target language • listen attentively and speak appropriately in small and large group interactions • use new words and phrases to help express ideas and feelings (for example, when describing experiences or talking about different types of texts) • choose texts to listen to and view, showing enjoyment and understanding by responding in oral, written or visual form, or through gestures • obtain simple information from accessible texts • predict likely outcomes when listening to or viewing texts.	• evaluate the accuracy of sources in a range of modalities • begin to paraphrase and summarize ideas and information drawn from texts • verbalize their thinking and explain their reasoning • reflect on and discuss elements of texts including the ideas, text structures and language features • use a range of specific vocabulary in different situations, indicating an awareness that language is influenced by purpose, audience and context • recognize expectations (for example, variations of languages may use different vocabulary or language features) • realize that grammatical structures can be irregular and begin to use them appropriately and consistently • appreciate that language is not always used literally; understand and use the figurative language of their own or another culture • use language to describe, explain and compare	• use oral language responsibly to inform, entertain and influence others • engage with a range of <i>multimodal</i> texts in order to generate, discuss, develop, and modify ideas and opinions • paraphrase and summarize when communicating orally, making use of note-taking strategies as appropriate • use oral language to negotiate, to formulate and communicate possibilities and theories • reflect on communication to monitor and assess their own learning and to set goals for future learning • justify their choices of modes of communication by considering their audience.	

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Oral language—listening and speaking				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
		- express thoughts, ideas, wonderings and opinions as part of their inquiries - participate in a variety of creative activities, for example, role plays, games, dramatization of familiar stories and poems - collaborate with others to create multimodal presentations - consider their audience when making choices about modes of communication - explain and discuss their own writing with peers and adults; respond to feedback.		

Strand: Visual language—viewing and presenting

Example concepts: communication, culture, data, equity, feature, gestures, imagery, influence, information, interpretation, meaning, media, multimodal, persuasion, purpose, resources, symbols, text.

Example conceptual understandings				
Strand: Visual language—viewing and presenting				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
The images, objects and symbols in the environment have meaning.	People draw on their own experiences and make personal connections to information presented visually.	Visual texts have the power to influence thinking and behaviour.	Visual communications can reflect cultural perspectives.	
People learn about the world through what they see, hear and feel.	Visual information and techniques assist interpretation and building understanding, and can engage the audience in different ways.	Images and persuasive language are used to attract readers and promote a viewpoint.	Visual texts can stimulate creative and critical thinking.	
People express themselves using visual techniques, including using static and moving images to tell stories.	Viewing and talking about images others have created help people to understand and create their own presentations.	Understanding the composition of visual texts facilitates communication and provides opportunities to discuss complex ideas.	Synthesizing information from visual texts is dependent upon personal interpretation and leads to new understanding.	

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Visual language—viewing and presenting				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners: - recognize and respond to familiar signs, labels and logos, (for example, road signs, classroom labels); identify similarities and differences - use appropriate <i>digital iconography</i> and movements (for example, scroll or swipe) to engage with activities and tools on technology devices - show understanding of visual information through play, gestures, facial expressions, and sharing with others - make personal connections to visual texts, for example, a picture book about children making friends in a new situation - show appreciation of illustrations in visual texts, for example, by selecting, revisiting or sharing familiar picture books and digital texts - select and incorporate colours, shapes, symbols and images into visual representations as part of play, for example, drawings and models - recognize the meaning of body language - start to share information and ideas using different media - show understanding of the images in stories through illustrations and role play.	Learners: - talk about their own feelings in response to visual messages; listen to others and show empathy for the way others might feel, realizing that people react differently - connect visual information with their own experiences - realize that text and illustrations in reference materials work together to convey information - attend to visual information showing understanding through discussion, role play, illustrations - understand that visual messages influence our behaviour - use body language to communicate ideas and feelings visually - use a variety of implements to practise and develop handwriting and presentation skills - recognize digital iconography and follow prompts to access digital tools for viewing and presenting - view visual information and show understanding by asking relevant questions and discussing meaning	Learners: - are able to express that visual texts have been created to reach a particular audience and influence them in some way, and make judgements about the effectiveness of visual messages - describe personal reactions to visual texts; reflect on why others may perceive the images differently - understand and explain how visual information and effects contribute to the understanding of different contexts, and can be used to reflect a particular context or perspective - discuss multimodal texts and show how the written, oral and/or visual language features work together to convey a particular message - prepare, individually or in collaboration, visual presentations using a range of media - engage with visual texts that present ideas and perspectives that may differ from their current understanding - realize that visual information reflects and contributes to the understanding of different contexts	Learners: - identify factors that influence personal reactions to visual texts - explain how cultural influences, for example, the use of colour and symbols, affect the interpretation of visual effects - analyse and interpret the ways in which visual effects are used to help people understand context - reflect on ways in which understanding the intention of a visual message can influence personal responses - examine and analyse multimodal texts, including print and digital texts, explaining how visual, oral and written information work together to reinforce each other and make meaning more explicit - analyse the selection and composition of visual presentations; select examples to explain how they achieve a particular impact, for example, dominant images, use of colour, texture, symbolism - design visual texts with the intention of influencing the way people think and feel - show how body language can be used to achieve effects and influence meaning in multimodal presentations	

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Visual language—viewing and presenting				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
	- observe and discuss information presented visually in a range of texts, including print and digital - through teacher modelling, become aware of terminology used to describe visual effects, for example, line, colour, shape, direction, size, layout, border, frame - view different versions of the same story and discuss the effectiveness of the different ways of telling the same story - view a range of visual language formats and discuss their effectiveness, for example, picture books, film/video, still images, posters, drama, webpages and games - show understanding of visual information through discussion, role play and illustrations - explore the way that shapes, symbols and colours can have meaning in visual texts - realize that effects have been selected and arranged to achieve a certain impact, for example, the way in which colour, lighting, music and movement work together in a performance	- experience a range of visual text formats; appreciate and describe why selected formats meet a particular purpose or achieve a desired effect - discuss and explain visual images and effects using appropriate terminology, for example, image, symbol, graphics, space, balance, techniques, composition - select and use suitable shapes, colours, symbols, layout, actions and body language for presentations - practise and develop handwritten presentation techniques - explore and discuss the effectiveness of tools used to create visual texts - use appropriate terminology to discuss visual texts, for example, logos, font, foreground, background, impact - recognize and name familiar visual texts and explain why they are or are not effective, for example, advertising, logos, labels, signs, billboards, websites, games, books - design and create visual texts using shapes, colours, symbols, layout and fonts to achieve particular effects; explain how the desired effect is achieved	- apply knowledge of presentation techniques in original and innovative ways; explain their own ideas for achieving desired effects - use a range of tools to prepare their own presentations - use appropriate terminology to identify a range of visual effects/formats and critically analyse their effectiveness, for example, mood, media, juxtaposition, proportion - communicate information and ideas effectively to multiple audiences using a variety of media, modalities and digital environments.	

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Visual language—viewing and presenting				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
	- observe visual images and begin to appreciate, and be able to express, that these have been created to achieve particular purposes - communicate information and ideas to familiar audiences using a variety of media and modalities.	communicate information and ideas to multiple audiences using a variety of media, modalities and digital environments.		

Strand: Written language—reading

Example concepts: bias, characters, codes, communication, creativity, elements, feature, genre, grammar, imagination, influence, information, meaning, organization, perspective, phonics, print, purpose, structure, style, symbols.

Example conceptual understandings				
Strand: Written language—reading				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Texts enable readers to learn about the real world.	People read to learn about and understand the lives of others and the world around them.	Reading helps people to think in different ways and develop new understandings.	Reading about issues of importance in the world helps to make learning meaningful.	
Written language works differently from spoken language.	Reading stimulates the enjoyment of imagined worlds.	Different types of texts serve different purposes.	Reading supports multiple perspectives and helps to develop an understanding of how people think, feel and act.	
Texts can contain pictures, symbols and words that convey meaning.	Words have the power to engage the imagination and develop creativity.	Applying a range of strategies such as making predictions, rereading and checking for comprehension helps people to read and comprehend new and more complex texts.	Synthesizing ideas and information from multiple texts leads to new ideas and understanding.	
There are established ways of setting out and organizing texts.	Consistent ways of recording words or ideas enable members of a language community to communicate.	The structure and organization of texts influences and conveys meaning, and identifying the main ideas in a text helps to determine what is important.	Effective writing has a structure and purpose, and stories have a sequence of events (plot) that help to make the author's intention clear.	
		Reading and thinking work together to enable meaning-making within and across different areas of learning.		

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Written language—reading				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners: - locate and respond to aspects of interest in self-selected texts (pointing, examining pictures closely, commenting) - show curiosity and ask questions about pictures or text - listen attentively and respond to stories read aloud - make connections to their own experience when listening to or “reading” texts - recognize familiar signs and symbols, words and numbers experienced in the real world - explore digital texts and interactive features such as games, video and audio links within these - enjoy listening to stories - choose and “read” picture books for pleasure - participate in shared reading, joining in with rhymes, chants, refrains and repeated text as they gain familiarity with the sounds and vocabulary of the target language - express opinions about the meaning of a story - show empathy for characters in a story - recognize their own first name	Learners: - select and reread favourite texts for enjoyment - participate in shared reading, posing and responding to questions and joining in refrains - participate in guided reading situations, observing and applying reading behaviours and interacting effectively with the group - listen attentively and respond actively to read-aloud situations; make predictions, anticipate possible outcomes - read and understand the meaning of self-selected and teacher-selected texts at an appropriate level - make connections between personal experience and fictional characters or real people they meet in texts - select and use non-fiction texts (for example websites, books) for the purpose of inquiry, with teacher guidance - understand that print is permanent; for example, when listening to familiar stories, notices when the reader leaves out or changes parts - read and understand familiar written texts from the immediate environment, for example, signs, advertisements, logos, iconography	Learners: - distinguish between fiction and non-fiction, and select books appropriate to specific purposes - discuss personality and behaviour of characters or real people they encounter in texts, commenting on reasons why characters or people might react in particular ways - understand and respond to the ideas, feelings and attitudes expressed in various texts, showing empathy for characters - read a variety of books for pleasure, instruction and information; reflect regularly on reading and set future goals - understand that stories have a plot; identify the main idea; discuss and outline the sequence of events leading to the final outcome - appreciate that writers plan and structure their stories to achieve particular effects; identify features that can be replicated when planning their own stories - respond to questions that require inference and draw conclusions - as part of the inquiry process, work collaboratively with others to access, read, interpret and evaluate a range of source materials	Learners: - read a wide range of texts confidently, independently and with understanding - work in collaborative groups to locate and select texts appropriate to the purpose and audience; share and reflect on perspectives - participate in class, group or individual literature studies, gaining an in-depth understanding of the text - compare and contrast two different but similar texts (for example, two novels with a similar theme, a book and the movie, a digital information text and one in print), commenting on their effectiveness and impact - recognize and reflect on unstated assumptions and biases - make inferences and be able to justify them - identify and describe elements of a story—plot, setting, characters, theme—and explain how they contribute to its effectiveness - gain an understanding of the work and style of a particular author, and appreciate what it means to be an author	

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Written language—reading				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
- distinguish between pictures and written text, for example, can point to a picture when asked - begin to discriminate between visual representations of a language (for example, recognize that symbols, numbers, letters and words or characters all have meaning but differ from each other) - begin to identify and recognize some patterns found in the written form and the sounds of that language - indicate where the teacher should start reading - handle books, showing an understanding of how a book works, for example, cover, beginning, directional movement, end - realize that the organization of digital texts is different from print texts	- develop personal preferences, selecting text for pleasure and information - identify the difference between fiction and non-fiction texts - understand and apply reliable strategies when decoding print (for example, phonemic awareness, sound-symbol, word-characters) - read texts at an appropriate level, independently, confidently and with good understanding - recognize examples of written texts in other languages in the immediate environment - understand how written language is represented symbolically by the relevant language community (for example sound-symbol, word-characters) - instantly recognize an increasing bank of high-frequency and high-interest words, characters or symbols - have a secure knowledge of the basic conventions of the target language(s) in printed text, for example, orientation, directional movement, layout, spacing, punctuation - identify and explain the basic structure and organization of texts - engage with digital texts and understand how to navigate and use some of the features, for example hyperlinks, audio, video options.	- identify relevant, reliable and useful information, and decide on appropriate ways to use it - recognize unstated assumptions and biases - skim and scan texts to decide whether they will be useful, before attempting to read in detail - use a range of strategies to self-monitor and self-correct, for example, morphology, meaning, context, rereading, reading on, cross-checking one of these sources against another - name a range of different text types, for example, instructions, poetry, plays, stories, novels, reports, articles - recognize the author's purpose, for example, to inform, entertain, persuade, instruct - identify and use the different parts of a text, for example, title page, contents, index, homepage, menu, hyperlinks - use a range of print and digital tools and resources, for example, information texts, dictionaries, bibliography tools, with increasing independence and responsibility.	- identify genre (including fantasy, biography, science fiction, mystery, historical) and explain elements and literary forms that are associated with different genres - appreciate structural and stylistic differences between fiction and non-fiction; show understanding of this distinction when structuring their own writing or speaking - appreciate authors' use of language and interpret meaning beyond the literal - recognize and understand figurative language, for example, similes, metaphors, idioms.	

Strand: Written language—writing

Example conceptual understandings				
Strand: Written language—writing				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Writing conveys meaning.	Written language works differently from spoken language.	Writing and thinking work together to enable people to express ideas and convey meaning.	Through writing, people can make connections to, and develop an understanding of others.	
People write to tell others about their experiences, ideas and feelings.	Written language is the visual representation/symbolization of spoken language.	The structure of different types of texts includes identifiable features that relate to the text purpose.	Synthesizing ideas enables writers to build on what they know, reflect on different perspectives and express new ideas.	
Everyone can express themselves in writing.	Consistent ways of recording words or ideas enable members of a language community to understand each other's writing.	Rereading and asking questions of ourselves when writing can enable more clarity of expression.	Writing improves over time through the process of planning, drafting, editing and revising.	
Writing represents spoken words visually.	Every language has particular features that are used by the language community.	Applying a range of strategies helps people to express themselves so that others can enjoy and/or learn from their writing.	Knowing the intention helps writers to plan and develop different forms of writing.	
	When writing, people can draw inspiration from the texts they read, listen to and view.	The way writing is structured and organized helps others to understand and appreciate it.		

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Written language—writing				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners: - differentiate between illustrations and written text - show curiosity and ask questions about written language - write their own name independently - choose to write as part of play, for example, a shopping list, doctor's notes, birthday cards - use their own experience as a stimulus when drawing and mark-making - plan for writing by talking about their ideas or sharing their drawings with others - experiment with mark-making and writing using different writing implements and media - state an idea for an adult to record in writing - participate in shared writing, observing the teacher's writing and making suggestions - listen and respond to shared texts, observing conventions of print, according to the target language(s) - write letters, characters, numbers and symbols appropriate to the context in which they are used	Learners: - enjoy writing and value their own efforts to communicate - write about their own ideas, experiences and feelings - use simple sentence structures in their writing - incorporate vocabulary used in their speaking in their writing - participate in shared and guided writing, observing the teacher's model, asking questions and offering suggestions - write to communicate to a particular audience, for example, instructions, a fantasy story, a caption to accompany images - write an increasing number of key personal words and high-frequency words independently - begin to reread their writing with the aim of ensuring that the meaning is clear - recognize that self-assessment and feedback from others can improve their writing - read their own writing to the teacher and to classmates, realizing that what they have written remains unchanged	Learners: - write independently and with confidence, demonstrating a personal voice as a writer - explain the purpose of their writing - write for a range of purposes, both creative and informative, using different types of structures and styles - develop content related to their inquiries - use peer and teacher feedback to improve their writing - explore publishing tools and resources to present work effectively - use appropriate writing conventions, for example, word order or punctuation as required by the target language(s) - show awareness of audience and adapt writing to suit the needs of different audiences - ask questions of themselves and identify ways to improve their writing, for example, "Is this what I meant to say?" "Is it interesting/relevant?" - write about a range of topics for a variety of purposes, using literary forms and structures modelled by the teacher and/or encountered in other texts	Learners: - write using a range of text types in order to communicate effectively, for example, narrative, instructional, persuasive - adapt writing according to the audience and demonstrate the ability to engage and sustain the interest of the reader - write independently and with confidence, showing the development of their own voice and style - use appropriate paragraphing to organize ideas - recognize and use figurative language to enhance writing, for example, similes, metaphors, idioms, alliteration - locate, organize, synthesize and present written information obtained from a variety of valid sources and different perspectives - use planning, drafting, editing and reviewing processes independently and with increasing competence - constructively provide feedback on the writing of peers - vary sentence structure and length - demonstrate an increasing understanding of how grammar and text conventions of the target language(s) work	

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Written language—writing				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
- point out similarities or differences to the writing system of their home language(s) if appropriate - show an awareness of the relationships between words they say and how they are represented in written texts.	- recognize how visuals can support a written text - connect written codes with spoken language and reflect this understanding when recording ideas - form written code (for example, letters or characters) conventionally and legibly, with an understanding as to why this is important within a language community - discriminate between types of code, for example, letters, numbers, symbols, words/characters - organize ideas in a logical sequence, for example, write simple narratives with a beginning, middle and end - comment on similarities and differences between the writing system of the target language(s) and that of their home language(s) (if appropriate) - use some of the conventions of written text, for example, sequence, spacing, directionality - explore writing as a means of sharing opinions and ideas, and developing their personal voice - write to convey meaning to others	- reread, edit and revise to improve their own writing, for example, content, language, organization - sensitively give feedback to the writing of others - use a range of strategies to record words/ideas of increasing complexity - use a variety of print and digital tools and resources effectively to check word accuracy, broaden vocabulary and enrich their writing - work cooperatively with a partner to discuss and improve each other's work, taking the roles of authors and editors - plan their writing using graphic organizers such as mind maps, storyboards, lists and headings - use note-taking strategies when gathering information from oral and visual texts - use print and digital resources and tools, such as dictionaries, a thesaurus, games and word banks to explore and extend their use of language - begin to paraphrase and summarize ideas and information drawn from texts - select vocabulary and supporting details to achieve desired effects	- use standard spelling or characters for most words - use print and digital tools and resources confidently and effectively to check word accuracy, broaden vocabulary and enrich their writing - paraphrase and summarize accurately and concisely when communicating in writing, making use of note-taking strategies as appropriate - use a range of vocabulary and relevant supporting details to convey meaning and create atmosphere and mood - use written language as a means of reflecting on their own learning - identify and describe elements of a story—setting, plot, character, theme - use a range of tools and techniques to produce written work that is effectively presented.	

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Written language—writing				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
	- use familiar aspects of written language with increasing confidence and accuracy, for example, spelling patterns, high-frequency words, key personal interest words - participate in conferences with teachers to monitor and document progress, and to agree on new learning goals.	- use appropriate punctuation to support meaning and for impact; use increasingly accurate grammatical constructs and text conventions - explore more complex sentence structures - use knowledge of written code patterns to accurately proofread their own writing and make some corrections and improvements - self-monitor and set goals for improvement.		

Language glossary

Digital iconography	Visual images and symbols displayed on a screen.
Multiliteracies	Multiliteracies include the ability to identify, interpret, create and communicate meaning across a variety of digital, visual, oral, aural and print forms of communication in multilingual contexts.
Multimodal	Multimodal texts enable meaning and can be constructed and presented/represented using multiple modes. Different modes such as print, visual and auditory modes often work together in texts. For example, as in picture books, cartoons, websites, TV programmes, graphic novels, advertisements, posters, video, performances and magazines.
Social dimension	Aspects of interaction with other people.
Symbolic representation	Symbolic representation is a process in which a mark, picture, object or gesture "stands for" something else conveying meaning, for example, letters, numbers, signs.
Text	Artefacts through which we access or present information. These might be oral, written, musical, artistic or multimodal, for example, a story, song, performance, film.
Transactional process	Each communicator is simultaneously a sender and receiver of messages. Meaning is co-created in the interaction by both communicators.
Translanguaging	Translanguaging is the term used to describe practices through which learners use the languages they have at their disposal to communicate and make meaning. In translanguaging, students select from and deploy their full linguistic repertoire, instead of keeping a narrow focus on a single language.